

UC4: View Bid History

Primary Actor: Bidder (or any site visitor, since transparency is meant to be public)

Stakeholders and Interests:

- *Bidder*: wants to verify the auction is genuine and see how active the bidding has been
- *Seller*: wants buyers to trust that the price reflects real competition, not manipulation
- *System*: must present bid data without exposing any bidder's identity

Preconditions:

- Item listing exists and has at least zero bids (empty history is a valid state)
- User has navigated to the item detail page

Postconditions (success):

- The bid history table is displayed, showing amount and timestamp for each bid, with bidder identities masked

Main Success Scenario:

1. User navigates to an item's detail page.
2. User clicks "View all bids" (tab or pop-up).
3. System retrieves all valid (non-withdrawn) bids for the item, ordered chronologically (most recent first).
4. System masks each bidder's identity (e.g., "Bidder #4" or scrambled partial username).
5. System displays the table: bid amount, timestamp, masked bidder label.
6. User closes the view or returns to the item page.

Extensions (Alternate Flows):

- **3a. No bids have been placed yet:**
 1. System displays an empty state: "No bids yet — be the first!"
 2. Use case ends.
- **3b. Some bids have been withdrawn (per UC3):**
 1. System excludes withdrawn bids from the public history entirely (they never counted toward the visible price trail).
 2. Use case continues at step 4.
- **5a. The same bidder placed multiple bids over time:**
 1. System still assigns that bidder a **consistent** masked label across all their entries in this item's history (e.g., always "Bidder #4" for that user on that item), so patterns are visible without revealing identity.
 2. Use case continues normally.

Special Requirements:

- Masking must be consistent per bidder *per item* — but should **not** be the same label across different items (so users can't be tracked across auctions by matching masked IDs).
- The underlying full identity (real user ID, timestamp to the millisecond) is still stored in the audit log (per UC1) — this use case only governs the *public-facing* view.
- Good candidate for a data-privacy/security test case: verify no API response (even raw JSON) leaks real usernames or user IDs in this view, only the masked label.